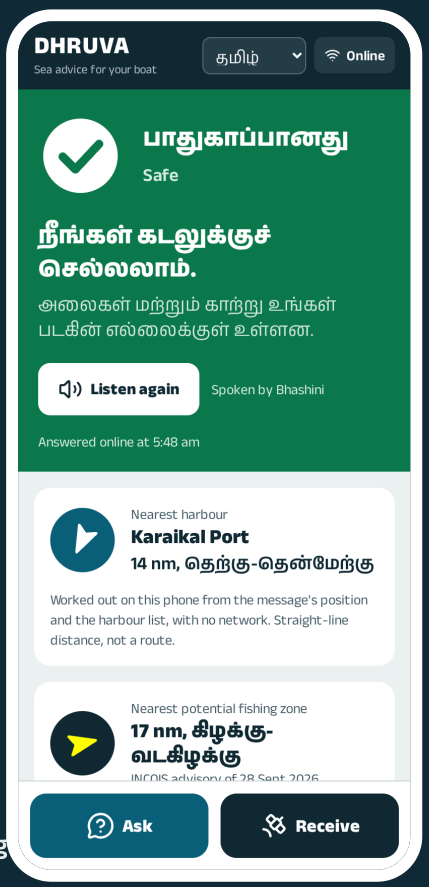
DHRUVA

Deep-sea Hazard, Routing & Understanding via Vernacular Agents

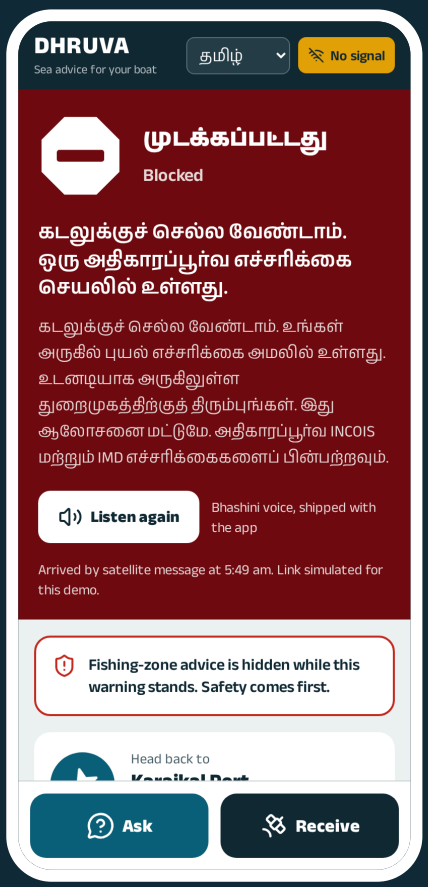
Ask the sea in your own language. The answer still reaches you when the signal is gone.

கடலிடம் உங்கள் மொழியில் கேளுங்கள்.

- Safe
- Caution
- Unsafe
- Blocked by an official warning
- No data, never guessed



Asked online in Tamil: a verdict for this boat, spoken by Bhashini.



No signal: a 145-bit message arrives and the phone speaks it.

The gap

India already sends warnings to boats at sea. No one answers a fisherman's question.

After Cyclone Ockhi in 2017, the lesson was that warnings existed but could not reach boats already at sea. ISRO and INCOIS have since built the channel, and it can even address a single boat. What it carries today is bulletins and broadcasts, written for a stretch of coast.

DAT-SG
ISRO's distress terminal. Receives control-room messages over NavIC and relays them to a phone over Bluetooth.

NavIC messaging
Satellite broadcast of fishing-zone and high-wave alerts from INCOIS.

GEMINI
INCOIS alerts over GAGAN, with an app in nine languages.

Nabhmitra / VCSS
Transponders with two-way messaging, warnings and fishing zones.

DHRUVA
Takes a question, reasons over live data for one boat, and answers in that fisherman's language.

Today: a warning for a coast

Warnings and fishing-zone advisories are issued by region and sector. No system we found answers a fisherman's question with reasoning specific to that boat.

A boat in the storm's path and a boat far outside it read the same regional bulletin.

DHRUVA's answer, for one boat

Blocked. Do not go to sea. An official warning is active. Spoken in Tamil, with the way back to Karaikal Port, 14 nautical miles south-south-west, on screen.

Built from that boat's position, its class and the live data, and delivered in one satellite message.

Integration, not invention

DHRUVA is built for Nabhmitra's two-way link and needs no new hardware. Nabhmitra's message format is not public, so the prototype is demonstrated against ISRO's published DAT-SG format. It replaces neither: it gives the channels ISRO already runs something worth saying to each boat, a specific, explained, spoken answer.

Sources: ISRO, ICD for DAT-SG emergency messaging via NavIC, v1.2; ISRO at UN ICG-16 (2022); PIB, GEMINI launch (2019); reporting on Cyclone Ockhi by The Wire and The News Minute.

What DHRUVA does

Three things, done properly.

Ask

In your own language, by voice. Speak a question in Tamil. Bhashini hears it, DHRUVA's agents check the sea for your boat, and Bhashini speaks the answer back.

Trust

Every number traced. A rule engine decides safety, not a language model. Every figure shows where it came from and when, or it is not shown at all.

Reach

Still there at sea. The whole answer fits in 145 bits: one short message to one boat. The phone rebuilds and speaks it with no network.

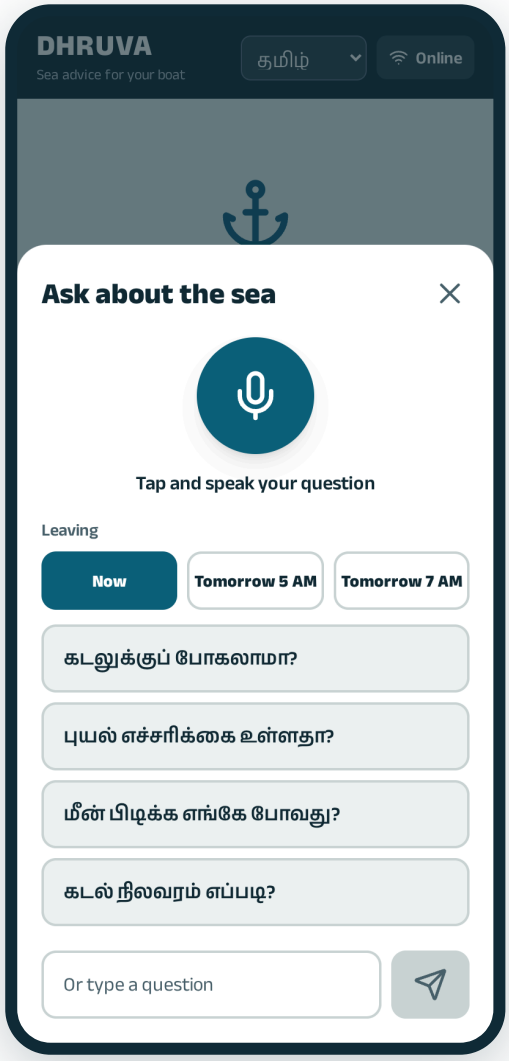
Built for the deck of a boat

Read in glare, without reading
Each verdict has its own colour, shape and word, like the signals hoisted at a port. Glare, a cracked screen or colour blindness does not hide it.

One tap, one hand
A large microphone, one-tap questions and buttons sized for a wet thumb.

Always the way home
Distance and direction to the nearest harbour, worked out on the phone from the message's position.

What if you leave at seven?
Choose now, tomorrow at 5 AM or 7 AM. DHRUVA checks that hour's forecast and shows whether the verdict changes.



The fisherman's phone

An answer for this boat, this morning, with its reasons.



Where the fish are, when it is safe

The nearest line of INCOIS's latest potential-fishing-zone advisory: distance, direction, date and what it was based on. Hidden automatically whenever a hazard is active.

The numbers behind it

Wave height, wind and sea temperature, each with its source, the hour it is valid for, how far away the grid point is, and the rule it was checked against. When a figure is rounded for the satellite message, the card says so: "0.3 m, sent as 0.25 m".

How it was worked out

The problem statement's nine agents, each with one line on what it found. Agents a question did not need are shown greyed out.

Spoken, and honest about the voice

Bhashini speaks the answer online. At sea the phone plays Bhashini clips shipped with the app. The screen always says which voice you heard.

Five languages on screen, twelve in the phrasebook

Tamil, Malayalam, Odia, Hindi and English in the app, with Bhashini voice in the four Indian languages. The offline phrasebook covers twelve.

Trust

A language model never decides whether you go to sea.

Many teams now say that. DHRUVA goes further: today's answers are built from checked templates, and any model-written text must pass the number check before it is shown.

1. Tools measure

Each reading becomes an evidence row: value, unit, dataset, the grid cell that answered, and when it is valid.

2. Rules decide

A deterministic rule table sets the verdict per boat class. A cyclone, lightning or tsunami warning forces NO-GO for everyone.

3. Words are checked

Every number in the answer, including Tamil and Devanagari digits and spelled-out numbers, must match an evidence row.

4. Or it is not said

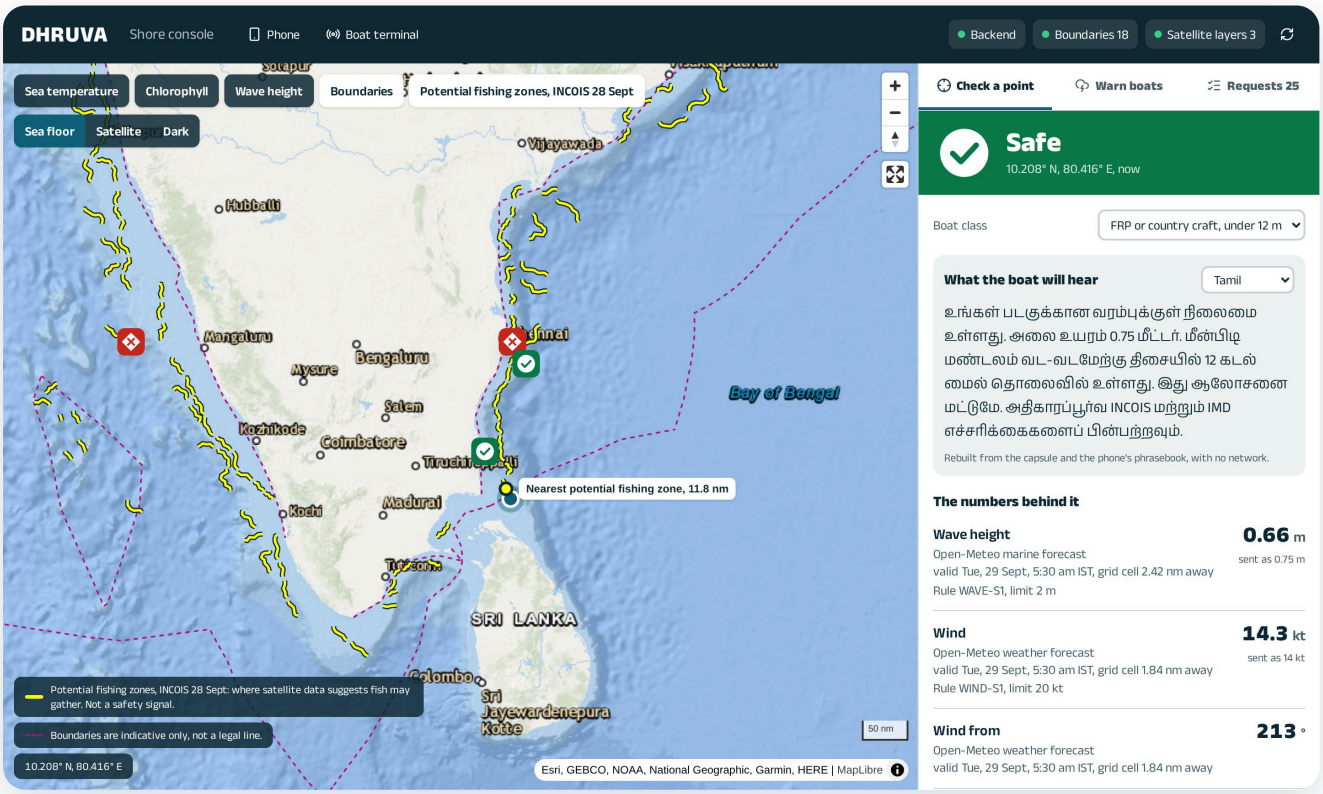
If the check fails, a plain template built only from the evidence is used instead. An unchecked sentence is never shown.

Missing data is never "safe"

If waves or wind cannot be fetched, the verdict is No data, with its own shape. A fishing-zone advisory more than three days old is treated as superseded and not offered.

Honest labels, everywhere

Forecasts are called forecasts. Maritime boundaries are marked indicative, never legal. Safety limits are marked provisional until they are replaced with published INCOIS criteria.

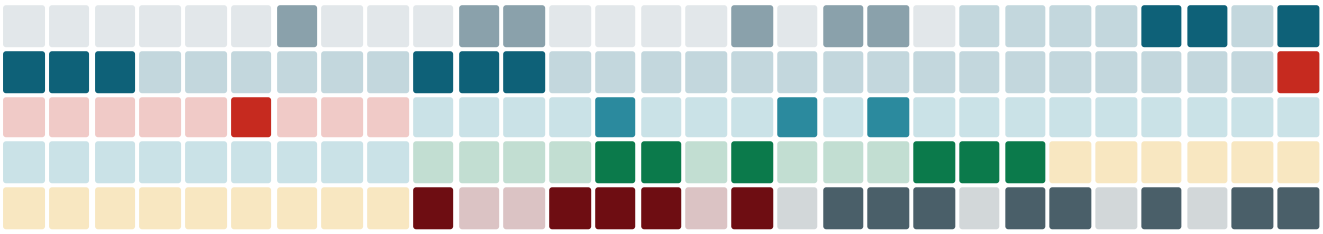


The shore console's point check: the verdict, the sentence the boat will hear, and every number with its source.

At sea, with no signal

The whole answer, in 145 bits.

A question goes up as one byte. The answer comes down as nineteen. The phone rebuilds the full spoken sentence, in the crew's language, from those bits and a phrasebook it already carries.



23 of 23

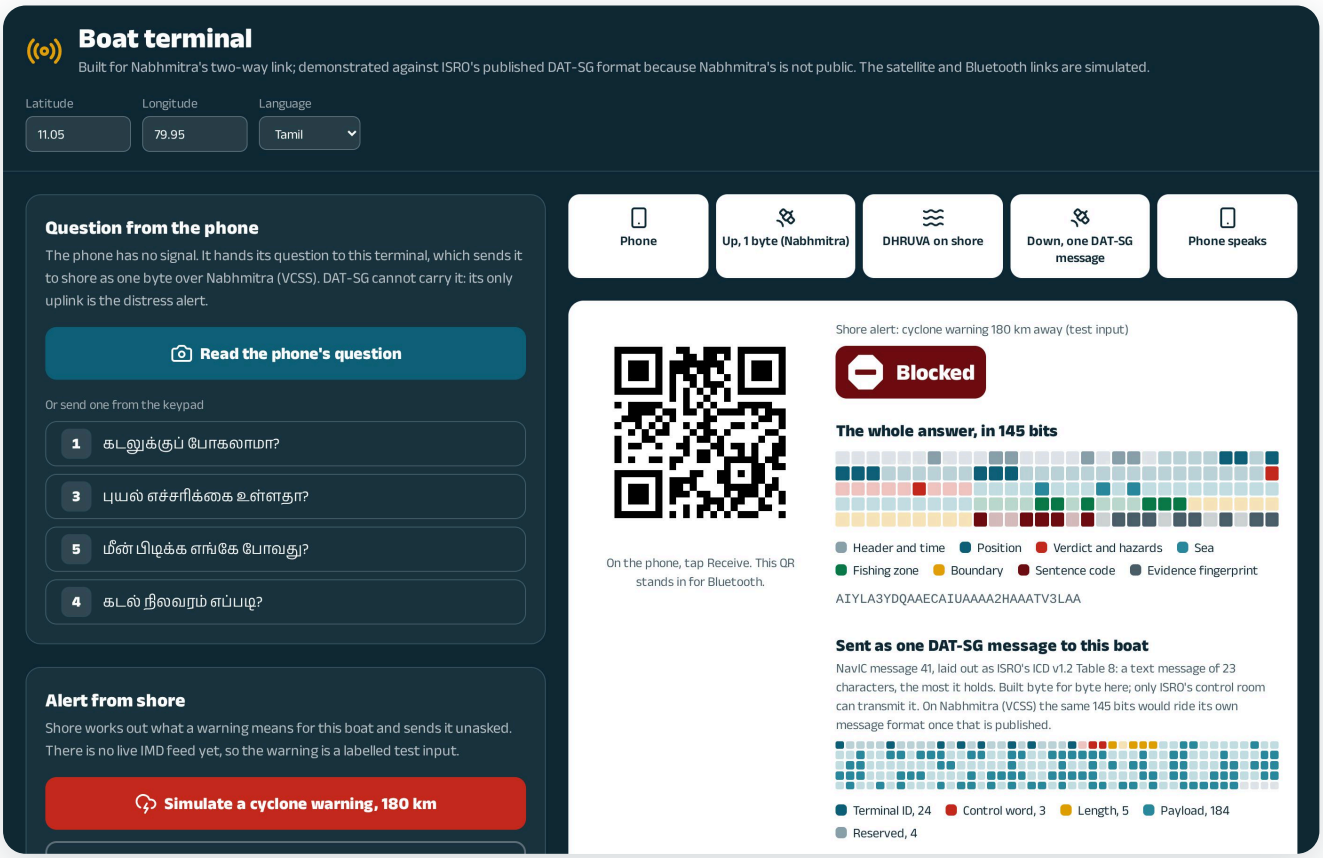
characters of one DAT-SG text message to one terminal, framed as ISRO's ICD v1.2 Table 8 lays it out.

145 bits

hold the whole answer. Every figure sits on a fixed grid, and every scale saturates rather than wrapping.

1 byte

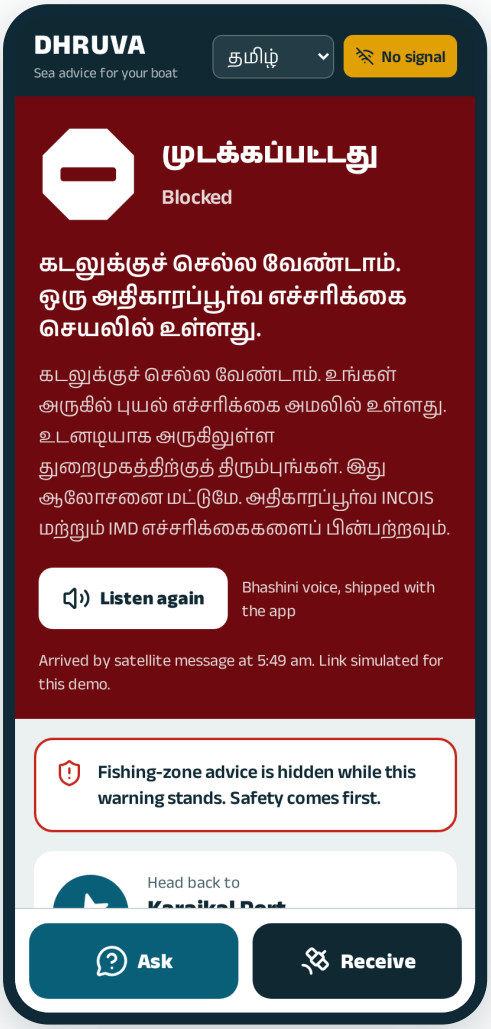
for the question going up, over Nabhmitra's two-way messaging. DAT-SG cannot carry it: its only uplink is the distress alert.



Built for Nabhmitra's two-way link; demonstrated against ISRO's published DAT-SG format because Nabhmitra's is not public. No team may transmit on ISRO's links, so a boat-terminal screen stands in for the terminals and a QR code for Bluetooth. The DAT-SG message is built bit for bit from the ICD and checked in tests.

What the fisherman hears

Airplane mode on. The warning still speaks.



Shore works out what a cyclone warning means for this boat and sends it, unasked. With no network at all, the phone:

Decodes the 145 bits

The decoder is pure: no network, no file access, no clock. The Python and TypeScript decoders are tested against the same 500-message corpus.

Speaks in the crew's language

Bhashini voice clips for every verdict, in Tamil, Malayalam, Odia and Hindi, ship inside the app.

Points the way home

Distance and direction to the nearest harbour, from the message's own position.

Reopens offline

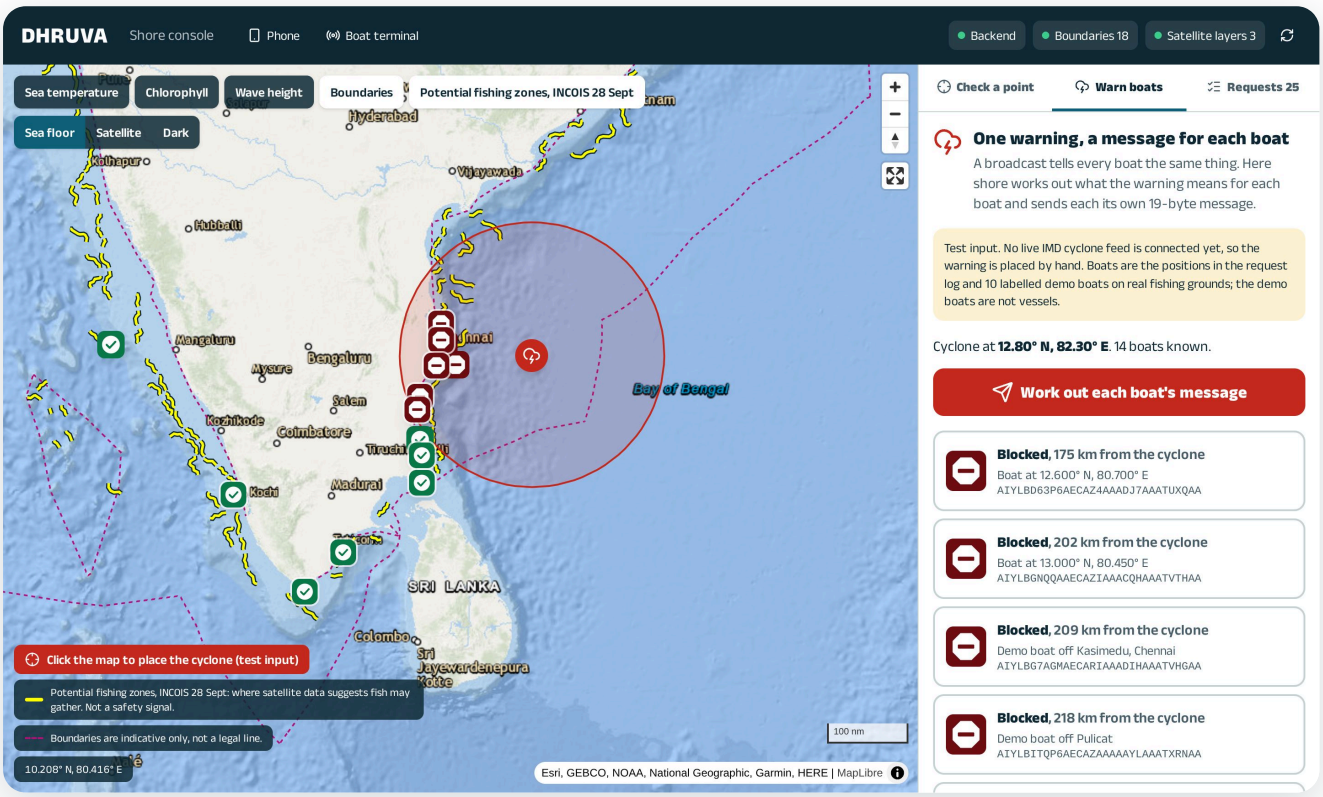
A service worker keeps the app, its fonts and its voice clips on the phone, so it opens with the radio off.

Shown: a simulated cyclone warning 180 km away, a labelled test input. DHRUVA has no live IMD cyclone feed yet.

The shore console

One warning in. A different message for every boat out.

Place a cyclone on the map. DHRUVA runs the full check for every boat it knows and gives each one its own nineteen-byte message: blocked inside 300 km, and the sea's own verdict outside it.



Check any point, live

Click the sea to see exactly what a boat there would be told, for any of three boat classes, with the evidence, the agent trace and the message itself.

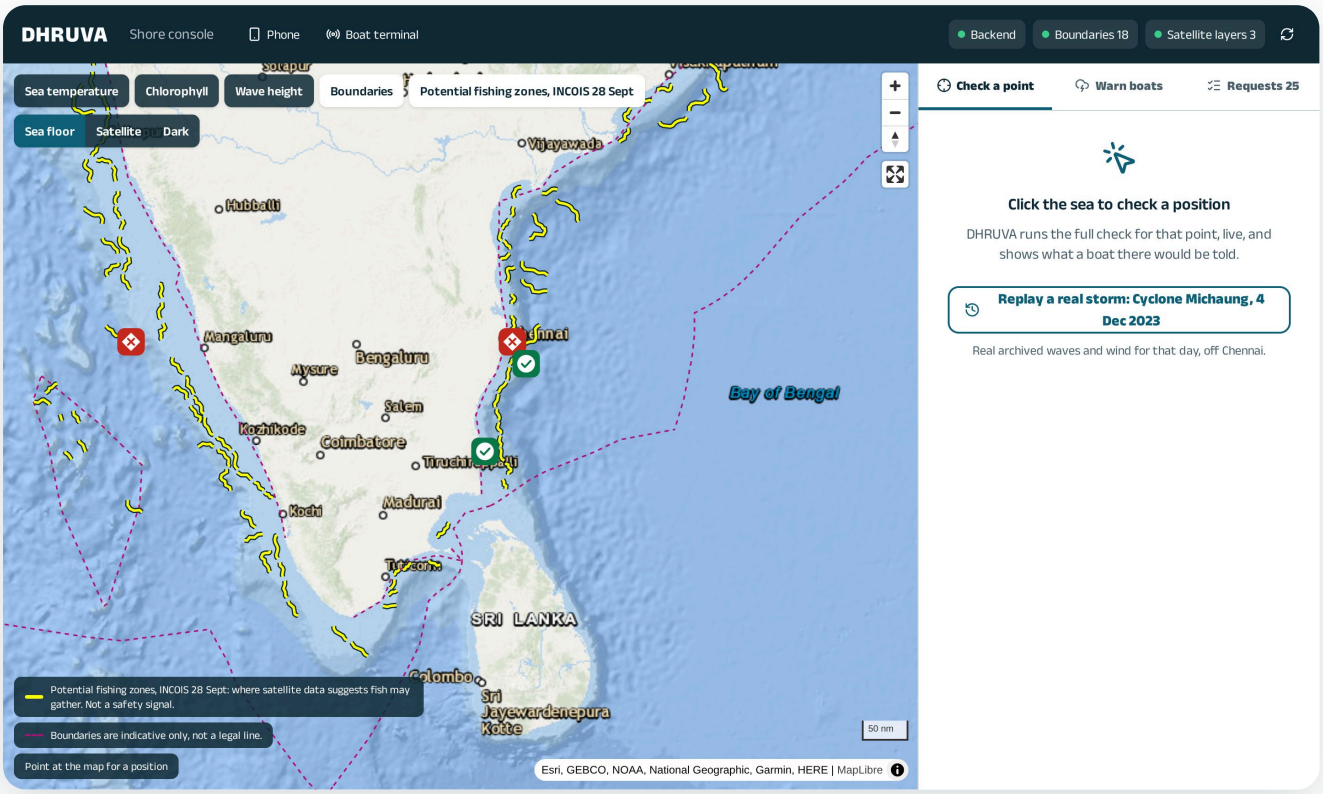
Replay a real storm

Cyclone Michaung, 4 Dec 2023, off Chennai: 4.68 m waves and 29.9 kt wind from the archives, and a NO-GO decided from data alone.

The cyclone is a test input, and the demo boats are labelled positions on real fishing grounds, not vessels.

The map

The sea floor, the fishing zones and the satellites, in one view.



INCOIS fishing zones

The lines of INCOIS's latest fishing-zone advisory, read from the map service behind its public geoportal, with the date and basis on every line.

Satellite layers

Sea temperature, chlorophyll and wave height from Copernicus Marine, served as map tiles.

Boundaries

EEZ and maritime lines from Marine Regions, drawn dashed and labelled indicative, never legal.

Base maps: sea-floor relief (Esri, from GEBCO and NOAA bathymetry), satellite imagery, or dark. No API keys and no quotas.

Data, stated plainly

What is live, and what is labelled.

Source	What DHRUVA uses it for	Status
Open-Meteo Marine	Wave height, wave period and sea temperature, by the hour	Live
Open-Meteo Forecast and ERA5 archive	Wind speed and direction; the archive replays past dates such as Cyclone Michaung	Live
Copernicus Marine	Chlorophyll, currents and the map's satellite layers	Live
INCOIS fishing zones	Fishing-zone lines and 1223 landing centres, from the map service behind INCOIS's geoportal. No documented API: read and attributed, with the date on every line	Live
Marine Regions (VLIZ)	EEZ, territorial sea and boundary lines, in PostGIS	Loaded
Bhashini	Speech recognition, translation and speech in Tamil, Malayalam, Odia and Hindi	Live
Gemini	Understands the question and plans which agents run. A keyword planner takes over when it does not answer	Live
IMD cyclone warnings	The warning override is built and tested; the live feed is not connected yet, so the demo's cyclone alert is a labelled test input	Test input
IMD RSMC bulletin, Cyclone Michaung	Tropical Cyclone Advisory No. 9, issued 0300 UTC 4 Dec 2023: the storm replay measures the boat's distance from the centre IMD published, and the evidence row cites it	Past, dated
Nabhmitra / VCSS	The channel DHRUVA is built for. Its message format is not public, so the one-byte question uses DHRUVA's own code	Simulated
DAT-SG message 41	The answer's frame, built bit for bit from ISRO's ICD v1.2. Sending it is simulated by a terminal screen and a QR code	Simulated
Safety limits	Engineering placeholders until replaced with INCOIS Ocean State Forecast criteria	Provisional
Regional wording	Verdict labels machine-translated with Bhashini, pending a native speaker's review	In review

For demonstrations, DHRUVA can replay recorded live runs if a source is down. A replayed answer always says so on screen, with the time it was recorded.

Brief compliance

The nine agents the problem statement asks for.

Agent	What it does in DHRUVA
Planning	Reads the question and decides which agents run, with Gemini
Marine data discovery	Finds which datasets can answer, for this place and time
Weather intelligence	Wind and waves at the boat's position, for the chosen departure hour
Ocean analytics	Sea temperature, chlorophyll and currents
Geospatial reasoning	Boundaries, maritime zones and the nearest INCOIS fishing zone, in PostGIS
Risk assessment	The deterministic verdict, per boat class, with warning overrides
Visualization	Chooses the cards and map layers that answer this question
Reporting	The evidence bundle, the number check and the 145-bit message
User interaction	The answer in the crew's language, by voice, online and offline

Built with

LangGraph agents on FastAPI and Python 3.12. PostgreSQL with PostGIS. React, TypeScript and MapLibre, with no map tokens. Bhashini for voice and Gemini for planning. The same message decoder in Python and TypeScript, checked against a shared corpus.

Tested

449 automated tests, including: a fabricated number must fail the check; missing data is never read as safe; a stale fishing zone is never offered; and fishing advice never shows above an active hazard.

ISRO built the channel. DHRUVA gives it something to say to each boat.

Advisory only. Follow official INCOIS and IMD warnings.